

Supermum!

Opossums live in the Americas. Unusually for marsupials, the mother has no pouch. Instead, her babies cling to her. Sometimes one mother can have up to 20 babies at one time!

Opossums are very good tree climbers.

In the pouch

Most marsupials have pouches. When the babies are born, they are as small as beans and wriggle straight into the pouch. They do most of their growing there, instead of in their mother's tummy.

The joey belonging to this mother is definitely big enough to climb out of its pouch.

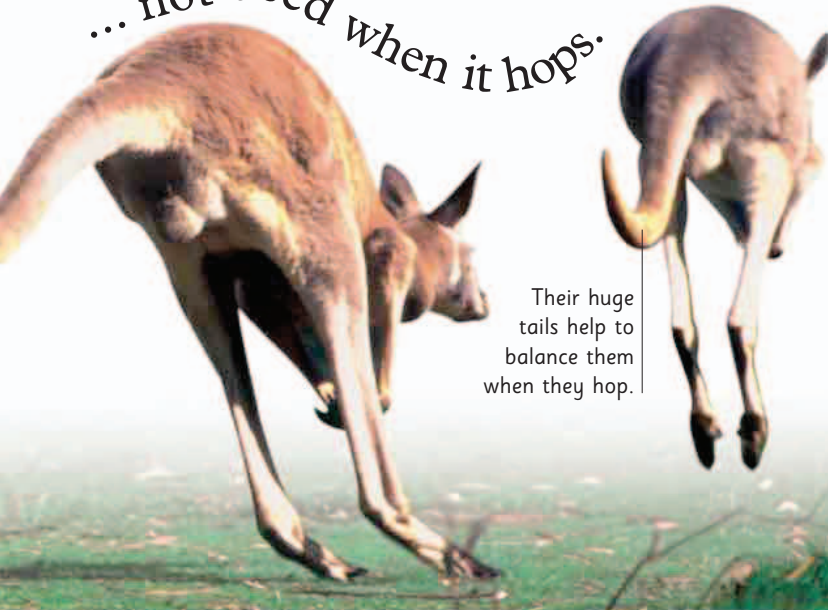
Little joey

Kangaroo and wallaby babies are commonly known as joeys. They spend several months in the mother's pouch, and even when they are big enough to walk, they sometimes jump back in for safety.



... not used when it hops.

Their huge tails help to balance them when they hop.



Kangaroos look like wallabies, but they are bigger.